

CRYPTOOPSEC

CryptoOpsec: Comprehensive Security Checklist

Cryptocurrency security represents a multifaceted challenge requiring systematic implementation across diverse protection domains. This comprehensive 50-point security checklist provides structured guidance for establishing robust protection across all aspects of cryptocurrency management, from fundamental account security through advanced protection mechanisms appropriate for significant holdings.

Effective cryptocurrency security requires defense-in-depth—implementing multiple overlapping protection layers that collectively provide resilience against diverse threat vectors rather than relying on single security mechanisms.

Account Security Fundamentals

Authentication Protection

- ❑ Implement unique, high-entropy passwords for all cryptocurrency-related accounts using password management solutions
- ❑ Enable application-based two-factor authentication (2FA) on all exchange accounts and web services
- ❑ Avoid SMS-based verification due to SIM-swapping vulnerabilities
- ❑ Consider hardware security keys like YubiKey for phishing-resistant authentication
- ❑ Implement separate email addresses dedicated exclusively to cryptocurrency accounts

Account Recovery Protection

- ☐ Document and securely store account recovery methods for all services
- ☐ Secure email recovery accounts with equally strong authentication measures
- ☐ Disable SMS recovery options when possible to prevent SIM-swapping attacks
- ☐ Store backup 2FA recovery codes in secure, offline locations
- ☐ Test recovery procedures periodically to ensure functionality

Wallet Security Implementation

Cold Storage Configuration

- ☐ Implement hardware wallets for significant long-term holdings
- ☐ Purchase devices directly from manufacturers or authorized resellers
- ☐ Verify device authenticity before initialization
- ☐ Update firmware to latest security-verified versions
- ☐ Configure PIN protection with automatic reset after multiple failed attempts

Seed Phrase Protection

- ☐ Record seed phrases on durable physical media (metal preferred over paper)
- ☐ Store in secure, disaster-resistant locations
- ☐ Consider geographic distribution of backups for disaster resilience
- ☐ Implement passphrase protection (25th word) for additional security layer
- ☐ Never store seed phrases digitally or in cloud services

Hot Wallet Security

- ☐ Limit hot wallet holdings to amounts required for active use
- ☐ Use non-custodial wallets that provide exclusive control of private keys
- ☐ Implement separate wallets for different blockchains or usage contexts
- ☐ Regularly verify wallet software authenticity and update to latest versions
- ☐ Consider open-source wallet solutions with security audit histories

Exchange Security Measures

Platform Selection

- ☐ Select exchanges with established security track records and regulatory compliance
- ☐ Verify insurance coverage for exchange-held assets
- ☐ Research historical security incident responses
- ☐ Confirm majority of assets held in cold storage
- ☐ Evaluate proof-of-reserve implementations

Account Hardening

- ☐ Enable all available security features including advanced verification requirements
- ☐ Implement withdrawal address whitelisting when available
- ☐ Configure withdrawal delays and notification systems
- ☐ Disable API access unless specifically required
- ☐ Regularly audit active sessions and connected applications

Device Security Configuration

System Hardening

- ☐ Maintain updated operating systems with security patches
- ☐ Implement full-disk encryption on all devices
- ☐ Consider dedicated devices for cryptocurrency operations
- ☐ Disable unnecessary services and connectivity options
- ☐ Implement automatic screen locking and authentication

Malware Prevention

- ☐ Install reputable security software with real-time protection
- ☐ Implement ad-blocking and script-blocking browser extensions
- ☐ Verify software authenticity before installation
- ☐ Scan for clipboard hijacking malware that modifies wallet addresses
- ☐ Consider application whitelisting for maximum protection

Network Security Implementation

Connection Protection

- ☐ Use VPN services when conducting cryptocurrency operations
- ☐ Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive transactions
- ☐ Configure secure DNS to prevent poisoning attacks
- ☐ Implement network-level ad and tracker blocking
- ☐ Consider Tor usage for maximum privacy protection

Browsing Security

- ☐ Verify website authenticity through URL inspection and SSL validation
- ☐ Use bookmarked links rather than search results or email links
- ☐ Implement separate browsers for cryptocurrency activities
- ☐ Enable phishing protection features
- ☐ Consider hardware security keys for website authentication

Advanced Security Measures

Multisignature Implementation

- ❑ Configure multisignature wallets for high-value holdings
- ❑ Distribute keys across different physical locations
- ❑ Document recovery procedures for authorized parties
- ❑ Test multisignature operations regularly
- ❑ Consider trusted third-party key holders for inheritance planning

Privacy Protection

- ☐ Implement coin mixing or CoinJoin for transaction privacy
- ☐ Consider privacy-focused cryptocurrencies for sensitive transactions
- ☐ Use separate addresses for different transaction contexts
- ☐ Avoid linking personal identity to cryptocurrency addresses
- ☐ Implement communication security for cryptocurrency discussions

Implementation Strategy

Security implementation should follow a prioritized approach based on holding value and threat model assessment. Begin with fundamental protections including strong authentication, seed phrase security, and basic device hardening before progressing to more advanced measures. This incremental approach ensures critical vulnerabilities are addressed first while building toward comprehensive protection.

Regular security audits should evaluate implementation completeness across all domains, identifying gaps and emerging threats requiring additional measures. This continuous improvement process acknowledges that security requirements evolve alongside both the threat landscape and your cryptocurrency portfolio value.

The optimal security posture balances protection strength against operational complexity, recognizing that excessive friction may lead to security shortcuts or errors. The goal is sustainable security practices that can be maintained consistently rather than perfect but impractical measures that deteriorate over time.